

You used to lay bricks.



Now a robot lays them faster.

Your value was never the bricklaying.
It was deciding where the wall goes.

Andrew Ng analyzed 10,000 job postings to find out which software skills matter now.

build & deploy AI · fundamentals · use agents well · shape the build

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Coding is the floor now,
not the ceiling.

Coding isn't one of them. Nothing here works without it.

01 BUILD & DEPLOY AI

control the unpredictable

02 FUNDAMENTALS

catch the tradeoff it made

03 USE AGENTS WELL

know the limits, calibrate trust

04 SHAPE THE BUILD

decide what's worth solving

Andrew Ng, from 10,000 job postings analyzed

Normal software is predictable. AI is not.

01 BUILD & DEPLOY AI

Ask it the same question twice,
get two different answers back.
Building the thing is not the skill.
Controlling it is.

**The real work is disciplined evals
and error analysis, measuring and
improving the system on purpose.**

Fundamentals matter more now, not less.

02 SOFTWARE FUNDAMENTALS

Every software decision is a tradeoff: fast, secure, cheap. Tell an AI to hit all three and it will quietly pick which one loses.

You won't know what it traded away until it breaks in production.
Fundamentals are how you catch it first.

Know what it's good at. Know where it isn't.

03 USE CODING AGENTS WELL

What agents are perfect at, their limits, and how much to trust them. Do it efficiently too, the time and tokens you burn count.

One small wrong instruction can wipe a production database.
Trust is calibrated, never assumed.

You're not an order-taker. You're the architect.

04 SHAPE THE BUILD

Deciding which problem is worth solving is part of the job now, not a bonus round after the ticket lands in your queue.

The robot lays the bricks.
You still decide where the wall goes.

One habit. One architect move.

SKILL 1

You ship the AI feature and hope it works

→ run evals, do error analysis

SKILL 2

You accept whatever tradeoff the AI made

→ name the tradeoff yourself, first

SKILL 3

You approve every agent suggestion by default

→ calibrate trust, verify the risky ones

SKILL 4

You wait for the ticket to tell you what to build

→ pick the problem before it's assigned

Still a bricklayer on the left.

Already the architect on the right.

Don't just learn to write code. Learn to think like a senior engineer.

THE FOUR, ONE MORE TIME

1. Build & deploy AI applications
2. Software fundamentals
3. Use coding agents well
4. Shape the build

Of the four, which one are you actually building, and which one are you just hoping the agent handles for you?